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DIGGERS

A contested-lane climbing card game for 2-4 players · *Dig it up before they do.*

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Tyrannosaurus	Triceratops	Stegosaurus	Brontosaurus	Pteranodon

The game

Rival paleontologists work the same badlands. Between every pair of neighboring camps is a dig site, and it belongs to whoever brought up the finer find there last. Play runs or sets from a hand you may never sort, poach bones from the sites beside you, and hand a specimen across in return. Three field seasons; most prestige wins.

Why it works

- **A hand you can't sort.** Only cards that sit side by side can be played together, so every turn is a small puzzle. Poaching lets you slot exactly the bone you need into the gap.
- **Every site is shared.** Every find you lay is a target. The specimen you send back for a poached bone can be a gift or dead weight.
- **A built-in arc.** Sites are worth 1, then 2, then 4 prestige, so the last season outweighs the first two. In simulated games the final season overturns the leader about a third of the time.
- **Five skeletons.** Each species' nine cards assemble into a fossil slab, and a suited run, all from one skeleton, outranks any set its size.

Season 1	Season 2	Season 3
Each site worth 1 prestige	Each site worth 2 prestige	Each site worth 4 prestige

At a glance

Players	2–4 (scales by deck and sites, no rule changes)
Genre	Climbing card game, area control
Length	15–20 minutes, 3 seasons
Components	45 fossil cards, 4 field guides, 4 named dig-site boards
Ready	Rules, print-and-play, browser build with tutorial, simulations

Play it now darrendon.github.io/games/diggers